

Try in two-movers

By C.G.S.Narayanan

TRY is a move that almost solves a problem, but is defeated by a single black defence, as opposed to the key which actually solves the problem. Variations after tries are called virtual plays which form an integral part of many thematic problems. Some problems employ several close tries by the same key-piece which add to the pleasure of solving. In problems with two or more phases (like zagoruyko) tries involve changed mates which make solving all the more difficult. In the problem below all the tries are by the key-piece WBb6 which commit a common error of coming in the way of his own queen five times.

C.G.S.Narayanan
5th place, 2 WCCT 1980



Mate in two moves

Try 1.Ba7? Kb7! (2.Qxa6?)
Try 1..Bc5? a5! ! (2.Qb5?)
Try 1.Bd4? Kd5! (2.Qc4?)
Try 1.Be3? Be4! (2.Qxe4?)
Try 1.Bf2? Bg2! (2.Qxg2?)

Key: 1.Bg1!! waiting

The white bishop has to choose his destination carefully. Note that after 1.Bc5? a5! (Not Kd5! 2.Ne7!-changed mate)

A try may lend plausibility to set play so

that the complete theme of a problem is brought home to the solver. Tries are employed in thematic compositions in more than one phase-set, try and key. Here is a zagoruyko with self-pins.

H.Hermanson, First prize
Bulletin Ouwier des Echecs 1953



Mate in two moves

Set: 1...cRxe2 2.Qc1; 1..eRxe2 2.Qf4
Try: 1.Nxb3? (2.Qc5) 1...cRxe2
2.bNd2; 1...eRxe2 2.Ne5 but 1...Na4!
Key 1.Nd3! (2.Qc5) 1...cRxe2 2.Nxb2
1...eRxe2 2.dNe5*

In the problem for solving (given below) the Italian maestro presents changed mates in zagoruyko for the promotions of BPe2

O.Stocchi
2nd prize, Litalia Schahhistica 1958



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Zagoruyko mutates':

Set: 1...dN any 2.Qxf4; 1...eN any
2.Qxf5 **Key 1.Qd8!** waiting 1...dN
any 2.Qd4; 1...eN any
2.Qxd5; 1...Kxe5 2.Re6

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